INCH-POUND

A-A-50194C
June 24, 2021
SUPERSEDING
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December 10, 2003

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HOOD, BALACLAVA, EXTENDED COLD WEATHER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) by all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers the extended cold weather balaclava hood which provides protection for the face, neck, and head in cold weather conditions.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The finished hood shall be of the following types and sizes as specified:

2.1 Types.

Type I - Hood (Single fabric design)
Type II - Hood (Multi-fabric design)

2.2 Sizes. The Type I hood shall be available in one (1) size to fit all (OSFA). The Type II hood shall be available in the following sizes:

SIZE SCHEDULE (Type II only):

SMALL/MEDIUM (S/M)
LARGE/X-LARGE (L/XL)

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data that may improve this document should be sent to: Attn: DLA Troop Support, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5096. Since contact information can change, verify the currency of the address information using Acquisition Streamlining and Standardization Information System (ASSIST) online database https://assist.dla.mil.

AMSC N/A FSC 8415

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Design and construction. The hood shall be a pull over the head style with an adjustable face opening, allowing it to be worn up over the nose, or down under the chin (see Figures 1 and 3). Type I hood shall have two (2) plies of the knitted cloth with a tightly woven nylon material, the weight shall be 4 (± 1) ounces when tested in accordance with ASTM D3776/D3776M, Option C. The wind barrier interlining between the plies in the face area shall extend a minimum of 5-inches past the top center of the hood and shall be anchored to prevent shifting. The interlining shall be caught in the binding all around the opening not affecting the stretch, to allow protection against wind. The interlining shall have a cut out in the mouth area. The face side of lining fabric shall finish toward the wearer. The Type II hood shall be a multi-fabric design using three (3) separate materials; one (1) for the shell, one (1) for the liner, and one (1) for the front panel covering the nose and mouth and extending to the bottom of the hood. The front panel shall be one (1) layer of fabric, and the rest of the hood shall be two (2) layers (shell and liner). The finished edges around the face opening and bottom edge of the hood shall be lined with binding tape. The materials covering the head shall partially overlap the mandible materials near the wearer's ears, allowing for the lower portion to be pulled down under the chin. The overlapping materials shall be secured with a bartack on either side of the face opening (see Figure 3).

3.2 Basic materials.

3.2.1 Shade matching (all types). The color and appearance of the dyed and finished cloths shall match the standard sample.

3.2.1.1 Knitted cloth (Type I). The finished cloth for the Type I hood shall be washable wool, not lower than 64's U.S Standard, which may be blended with a maximum of 15 percent synthetic fiber, and dyed Black 470. The finished cloth shall conform to the requirements listed in Table I when tested as specified in Table I.

TABLE I. Knit cloth physical requirements (Type I).

Characteristics	Requirement	Test Method
Fiber identification	3.2.1.1	ASTM D3887
Fiber blend	3.2.1.1	ASTM D3887
Knit structure	1 x 1 rib	Visual 1/
Weight, oz./sq. yd. (minimum) 2/	8.0	ASTM D3887
Wales and courses per inch 3/	5 x 12	ASTM D3887
Colorfastness to: (minimum)		
Crocking, wet and dry	4	AATCC TM8
Perspiration 4/	4	AATCC TM15
Laundering	4	AATCC TM61, Test IA
Visual shade matching	3.2.1	5/

1/ One (1) sample shall be used to visually determine the requirement. The results shall be reported as pass or fail.
2/ Requirement for single ply of the base knit material
3/ The wales shall be counted on one (1) side of the fabric only.
4/ The test for colorfastness for acid and alkaline solution shall apply.

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5/ The color and appearance of the Type I balaclava cloth shall match the standard sample when viewed using the AATCC EP 9, Option C (see 7.3.1), with sources simulating artificial daylight D_{75} illuminant with a color temperature of 7500K (± 200) illumination of 100 (±20) foot candles, and shall be a good match to the standard sample under incandescent A illuminant with a color temperature of 2856K (± 200).

3.2.1.2 Thread (Type I). The thread for seaming and edge finishing shall be Black 470, C.A. 66043, polyester or cotton-covered conforming to A-A-50199, Type I or II, Tex size 46-60, 2 or 3 ply or Tex size 36-45, 2 ply.

3.2.1.3 Interlining (Type I). The wind barrier interlining shall be a tightly woven nylon material conforming to the requirements in Table II when tested as specified in Table II.

TABLE II. Interlining (Type I) physical requirements.

Characteristics	Requirements	Test Method
Air Permeability, ft^3 /min/ft^2 (maximum)	15	ASTM D737
Colorfastness to: (minimum)		
Perspiration	4	AATCC TM15 1/
Laundering	4	AATCC TM61, Test 1A 2/

1/ The test for colorfastness for acid and alkaline solution shall apply.
2/ The specimen shall be dried after each of the three (3) laundering cycles. The soap solution shall contain 0.5 % by weight, P-D-245, detergent, laundry, and hand dishwashing (granular) Type II in water hardness not over 50 parts per million. The weight of the specimen shall be 4.0 (± 0.5) grams for yarn and fabrics and the rotating time shall be 30 minutes with ten stainless steel balls in each cylinder.

3.2.1.4 Seams and stitching (Type I). All seams and stitches shall be in accordance with ASTM D6193. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams sewn so that no raw edges, runoffs, pleats, puckers or open seams occur. Thread tension shall be maintained so that no tight or loose stitching will result. Overedge stitching shall be 3/16 to 1/4-inch wide. Type 401 or 504 stitching shall be used to seam the upper portion of the hood together. Both ends of the stitching produced with the 401 stitching shall have a 1/2-inch chain extending beyond each end. Type 504 or 505 stitching shall be used on face opening and bottom edges of hood.

3.2.1.5 End item performance testing (Type I). The finished hood shall neither shrink nor elongate more than 7.0 percent maximum in either the length or width direction when test in accordance with AATCC TM135, Table I, (2), (II), (D).

3.2.2 Shell (Type II). The finished cloth for the outer shell shall be a woven cloth consisting of synthetic fiber and treated with a durable water repellant finish. The finished material shall conform to the requirements specified in Table III, when tested as specified in Table III.

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TABLE III. Physical requirements, shell (Type II).

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Weight, oz/yd^2	3.80 - 4.20	ASTM D3776/D3776M
Stretch, percent Warp Filling	 37 - 45 57 - 70	ASTM D4964
Air permeability, ft^3 /min/ft^2	65 - 85	ASTM D737
Dimensional stability, percent (maximum after three (3) cycles) Warp Filling	 5.0 5.0	AATCC TM135, Test 1, IV, A
Spray Rating, initial	90, 90, 80	AATCC TM22
Visual Shade Matching	3.2.1	1/

1/ The color and appearance of the Type II balaclava cloth shall match the standard sample when viewed using the AATCC EP 9, Option C (see 7.3.1), with sources simulating artificial daylight D_{75} illuminant with a color temperature of 7500K (± 200) illumination of 100 (±20) foot candles, and shall be a good match to the standard sample under incandescent A illuminant with a color temperature of 2856K (± 200).

3.2.2.1 Color (Type II). Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the color of the Type II shell, front panel, and binding tape shall be Coyote 498, and the color of the liner shall be Black 557 or Coyote 498.

3.2.2.2 Liner (Type II). The finished material for the liner shall be a lofted insulation without a backing cloth. The finished material shall conform to the requirements specified in Table IV, when tested as specified in Table IV.

TABLE IV. Physical requirements, liner (Type II).

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Weight, oz./yd^2	2.30 - 2.80	ASTM D3776/D3776M
Stretch, percent (minimum) Length Width	 10 40	ASTM D2594, loose fitting
Air permeability, ft^3 /min/ft^2	800 - 1,100	ASTM D737
Colorfastness (minimum) Crocking Wet Dry Perspiration Laundering	 3 4 3 3	 AATCC TM8, 1/ AATCC TM15, 2/ AATCC TM61, 2/, 3/

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TABLE IV. Physical requirements, liner (Type II). - Continued

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Dimensional stability, percent (maximum) after three (3) cycles Length Width	 5.0 5.0	AATCC TM135, Test 1, IV, A
Thermal insulation, clo	0.50 – 0.80	ASTM F1868, Part A

1/ Rated using the AATCC EP8, AATCC 9-Step Chromatic Transference Scale.
2/ Rated using the AATCC EP1, Gray Scale for Color Change and AATCC EP2, Gray Scale for Staining.
3/ Cold wash (80° F, 50 steel balls, 45 minutes)

3.2.2.3 Front panel (Type II). The finished cloth for the front panel shall be a knit cloth with a fleece back consisting of synthetic fiber and treated with a durable water repellant finish. The finished material shall conform to the requirements specified in Table V, when tested as specified in Table V.

TABLE V. Physical requirements, front panel (Type II).

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Weight, oz./yd^2	8.10 – 9.50	ASTM D3776/D3776M
Stretch, percent (minimum) Wales Courses	 35 45	ASTM D2594, form fitting
Air permeability, ft^3 /min/ft^2	40 – 90	ASTM D737
Colorfastness (minimum) Crocking Wet Dry Perspiration Laundering	 3 4 3 3	 AATCC TM8 AATCC TM15 AATCC TM61, 1/
Dimensional stability, percent (maximum) after three (3) cycles Length Width	 5.0 5.0	 AATCC TM135, Test 1, IV, A
Pilling, rating (minimum)	3	ASTM D3512, 30 minutes
Spray Rating, initial	90, 90, 80	AATCC TM22

1/ Cold wash (80° F, 50 steel balls, 45 minutes)

3.2.2.4 Binding tape (Type II). The binding tape around the face opening and along the bottom edge of the hood shall be an elasticized material, 1-1/2-inches in width.

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3.3 Measurements. The hoods shall meet the finished measurements specified in Table VI for Type I, and Table VII for Type II, when measured according to the footnotes. (see Figures 2 and 4).

TABLE VI. Finished measurements (Type I).

	Finished measurements (inches)	Tolerance (inches)
(A) Length	19	± 1
(B) Width	8-1/4	± 1/2
(C) Face opening	7-1/4	± 1/4

(A) Place hood on a flat surface and align bottom edges of front and back, close top and bottom edges of the face opening. With hood in this position, measure length in a straight line from folded edge at center of crown to bottom of hood (see Figure 2).
(B) With hood positioned as indicated above, measure across the hood in a straight line from folded edge to folded edge at face opening (see Figure 2).
(C) Place hood on a flat surface and fold in half lengthwise, pull hood so the curvature along side edges of face opening is straight. Measure along the edge of face opening from fold at center front to fold at center neck (see Figure 2).

TABLE VII. Finished measurements (Type II).

Size	Small/Medium	Large/X-Large	Tolerance
(D) Length, inches	15-1/2	16-1/2	± 1
(E) Width, inches	10	10-1/4	± 1/2
(F) Face opening, inches	2	2-1/4	± 1/2

(D) Place hood on a flat surface so that the bottom edge of the front extends approximately 2-1/4 inches past the bottom edge of the back. Press top and bottom edges of face opening flat. With the hood in this position, measure length in a straight line from folded edge at center of crown to front bottom edge of hood (see Figure 4).
(E) With the hood positioned as indicated above, measure across the hood in a straight line from folded edge to folded edge at the widest point between the face opening and bottom edge. (see Figure 4).
(F) Place hood on a flat surface and fold in half lengthwise so that the side profile of the face opening lays flat and creates a “C” shape. Measure in a straight line from top to bottom of face opening (see Figure 4).

3.4 Weight (Type II). The weight of the finished Type II hood shall be in accordance with Table VIII.

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TABLE VIII. Weight of finished hood, Type II.

Size	Small/Medium	Large/X-Large	Tolerance
Weight of finished hood, oz.	2.0	2.5	± 0.5

3.5 Labels. Each hood shall have an identification and a care label attached. The Type II hood shall also have a size label attached. The labels may be combined. The labels shall be in accordance with MIL-DTL-32075, Type V or Type VI, except the font size shall be 10 points. Class 4 of the MIL-DTL-32075 shall be used for the identification and size labels, and Class 3 shall be used for the care label. When the labels are combined the item description shall be omitted from the Class 3 label.

3.5.1 Identification and size label. The label shall contain the item description, size, National Stock Number (NSN), contract number, contractor's name, and Fur, Wool, or Fiber Products Act information.

3.5.2 Care label.

3.5.2.1 Type I. The care label for Type I shall be the following:

TYPE I:
WASH BY HAND, COOL WATER
SQUEEZE, DO NOT WRING
LAY FLAT, SHAPE, AIR DRY
DO NOT MACHINE WASH, DRY OR BLEACH

3.5.2.2 Type II. The care label for Type II shall be the following:

TYPE II:
WASH IN COLD WATER WITH LIKE COLORS.
DO NOT BLEACH, IRON OR DRY CLEAN
DRIP DRY

3.5.3 Barcode label/hang tag. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, each packaged hood (see 6.1) shall have a barcode label/hang tag conforming to Type VII, Class 17 of MIL-DTL-32075. The bar coding element shall be a 13 digit National Stock Number (NSN). There shall be a 12 digit Universal Product Code (UPC) number assigned for all NSN's by the contracting activity. The initials "UPC" must appear beneath the code. The bar code for NSN and UPC type shall be a medium to high density and shall be human-readable interpretation (HRI), located so that it is completely visible on the item when folded and/or packaged as specified causing no damage to the item.

3.6 Figures. Figures are furnished for information purposes only. When inconsistencies exist between the written specification and the figures, the written specification shall control.

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3.7 Toxicity. The materials for the finished hoods shall not present a health hazard and shall show compatibility with prolonged direct skin contact when tested as specified in 5.6. Chemicals recognized by the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) as human carcinogens shall not be used. (See 7.1.2).

3.8 Workmanship. The hood shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality limits.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Unless otherwise specified, the offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered, recycled, bio based, and environmentally preferable materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403, 23.404(b) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation FAR, or the sustainable acquisition of EO 13693; as applicable. (See 7.1.2).

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The hood shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Market acceptability. The hood offered or generic equivalent, must have been sold to the government or commercial market.

5.3 End item inspection procedures. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection of Attributes (see 7.2.3).

5.4 Visual examination. The balaclava hood shall be examined for the defects listed in Table VIII. The lot size shall be expressed in units of hoods. The sample unit is one (1) hood. The inspection level and AQL shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order. Unless otherwise specified, scoring shall be performed on defects visible from a normal inspection distance of 3-feet.

TABLE VIII. Visual defects.

Examine	Defect
Material and workmanship	Any hole, cut, tear, missing, broken, or loose yarn, needle chew, or weakening defect in the material Seams: puckered, distorted, pleated, wavy, twisted, irregular or open, loose stitch tension resulting in loose seam; seam type not as specified, raw edges. Stitches: broken or missing thread or stitch, stitch type not as specified, any run or dropped stitches Any thin areas, mends, or patches Any material defects, distorted parts or poor workmanship Any component part omitted or not as specified, distorted, full, tight or twisted parts. Any defect not specified in this table which affects, form, fit or function.

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TABLE VIII. Visual defects. - Continued

Examine	Defect
Color	Any shade variation within a part or between parts Color not as specified
Cleanliness	Any spot or stain on outside clearly noticeable Any excessive thread ends not trimmed or removed, raw edges Any odor affecting serviceability
Labels	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, not attached where specified; barcodes omitted, not readable by scanner; human-readable interpretation (HRI) omitted or illegible; barcode not visible on folded, packaged item; bar code attachment causes damage to the item
Marking	Marking missing, incorrect or illegible
Packaging	Any hood not packaged in accordance with the contract or purchase order.

5.5 End item dimensional examination. The hood shall be examined for conformance to the finished measurements specified in Tables VI and VII. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of hoods. The sample unit shall be one (1) hood. The inspection level, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

5.6 Toxicity test. When required (see 7.6), an acute dermal irritation study and a skin sensitization study shall be conducted. When the results of the studies indicate the hood is not a sensitizer or irritant, a Repeat Insult Patch Test shall be performed in accordance with the Modified Draize Procedure (see 7.2.5). If the toxicity requirement (see 3.7) can be demonstrated with historical use data, on the finishing treatments used, toxicity testing may not be required.

5.7 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 7.6).

6. PACKAGING

6.1 Packaging. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or purchase order (see 7.6).

7. NOTES

7.1 Source of Government documents.

7.1.1 Copies of Government documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.

7.1.2 EPA and EO 13693 information are available online at https://www.epa.gov.

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7.2 Source of non-Government documents.

7.2.1 AATCC Test Methods are available online at https://www.aatcc.org.

7.2.2 ASTM Test Methods are available online at https://www.astm.org.

7.2.3 ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection of Attributes are available online at https://asq.org.

7.2.4 Repeat Insult Patch Test - Modified Draize Procedure -Principles and Methods of Toxicology, A Wallace Hayes (editor) are available online at https://www.crcpress.com.

7.3 Standard samples. For access to standard samples address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal.

7.3.1 Visual shade matching. In 2017, Option A of AATCC Evaluation Procedure 9, Visual Assessment of Color Difference of Textiles was changed to Option C. NOTE: In case of confusion, the viewing geometry should be "The specimen plane and illumination source will be parallel to each other and aligned so that the light flux is incident at the center of the specimen plane, which is set at a 35 (± 5º) angle relative to the horizontal. The observer will view the specimens at a 90º angle, relative to the plane of the specimens.".

7.4 Intended use. These hoods are intended for wear by male and female military personnel of the Department of Defense operating in cold weather environments.

7.5 Certificate of compliance. The contracting activity may select to accept a certificate of compliance for stated requirement.

7.6 Ordering data. The contract or purchase order should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
b. Size required (see 2.1).
c. Labeling information (see 3.5).
d. When toxicity testing is required (see 3.7 and 5.6).
e Regulatory requirements (see 4).
f. Product conformance provisions (see 5.1).
g. Acceptance criteria (see 5.7).
h. Packaging requirement (see 6.1).

7.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Headwear
Knitted cloth
Water repellent
Wind barrier

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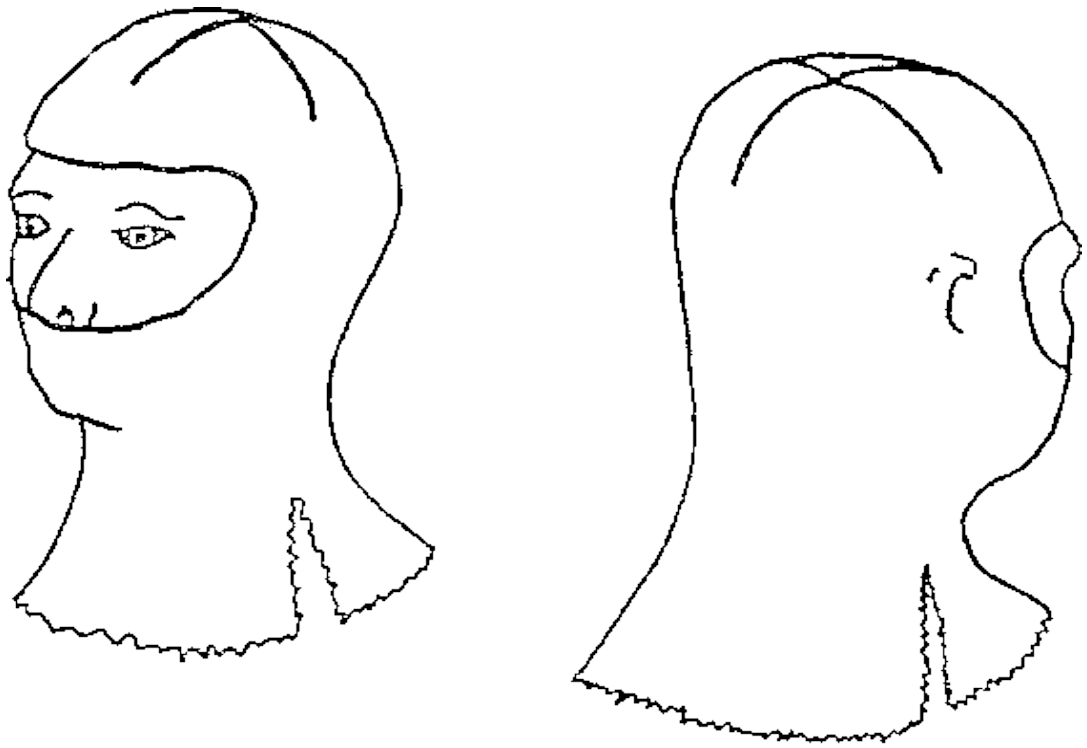


FIGURE 1. Hood, Balaclava, ECW (Type I).

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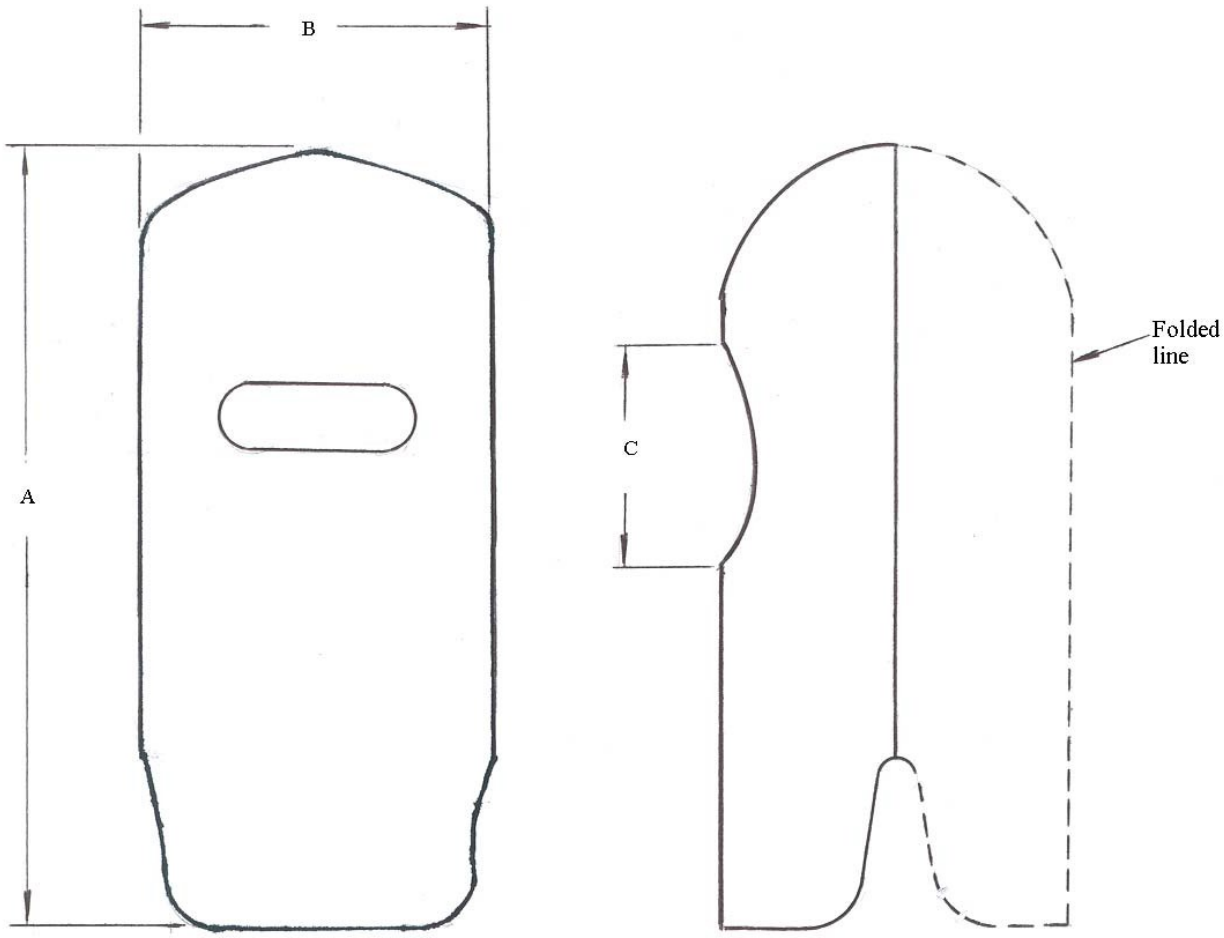


FIGURE 2. Measurement Guidelines (Type I).

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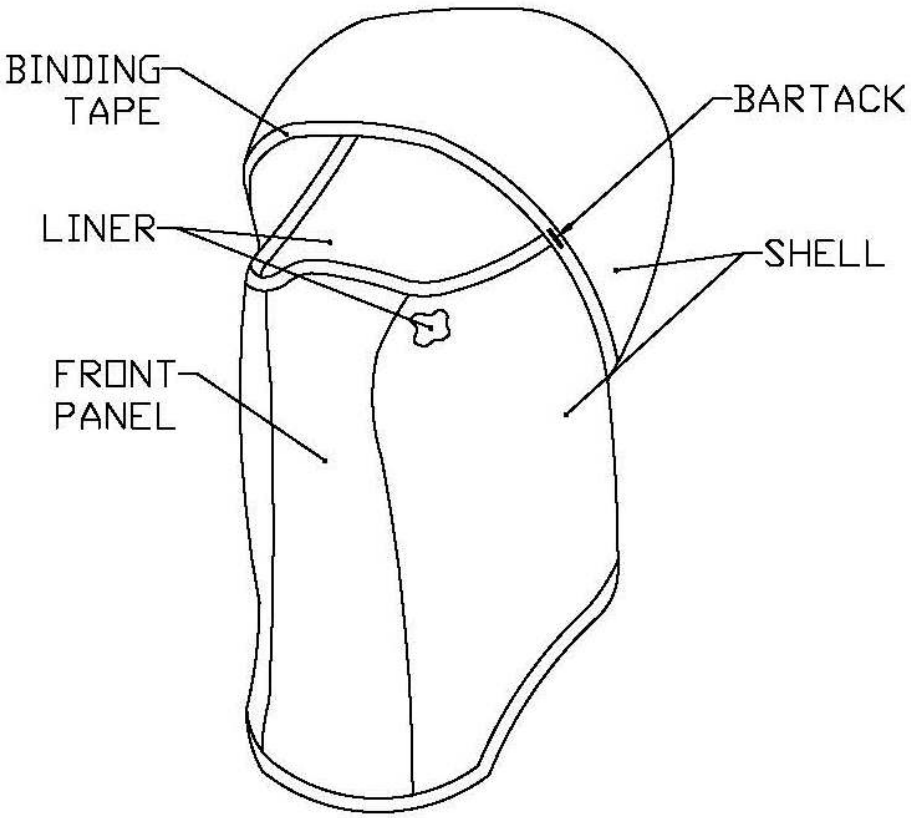


FIGURE 3. Hood, Balaclava, ECW (Type II).

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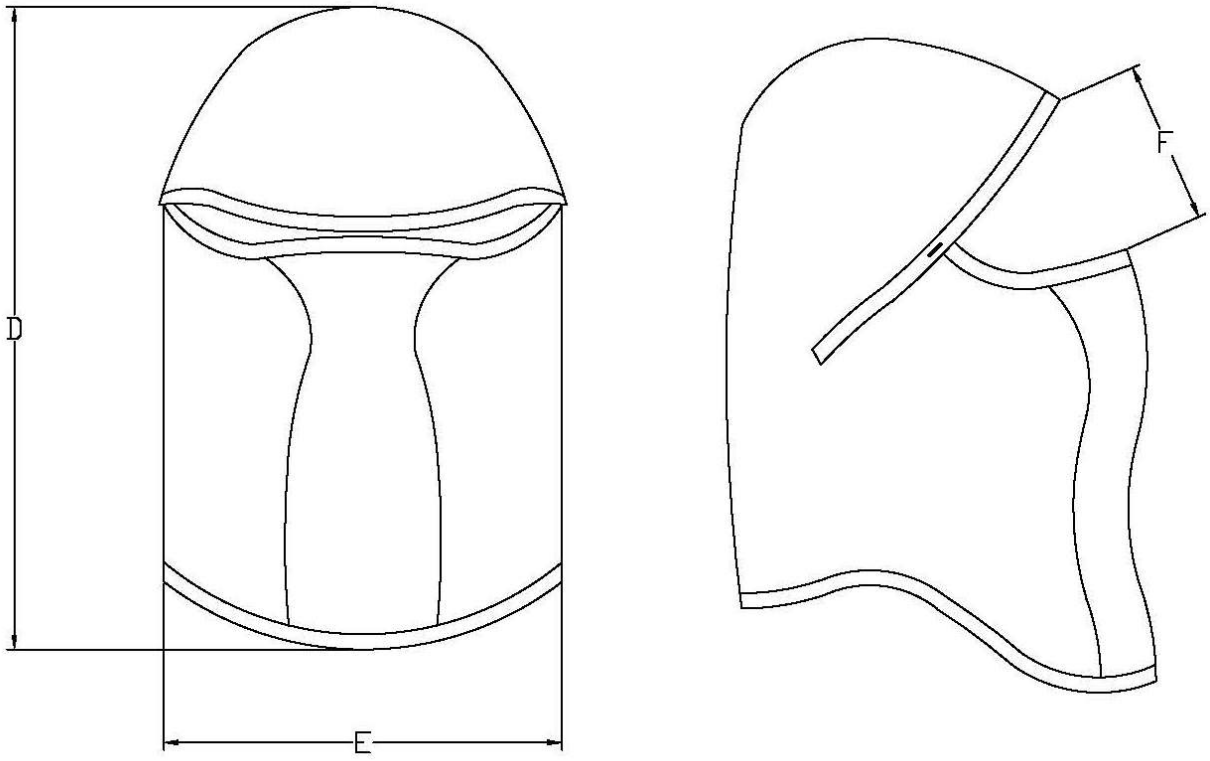


FIGURE 4. Measurement Guidelines (Type II).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians
Army - GL
Navy – NU
Air Force – 11

Review activities
Navy-MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY: GSA - FAS

Preparing Activity:
DLA -CT

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